of immediate perception, if established, would add weight to the subjectivist theory of 'Vijnānavāda.' Therefore, Kumārila, like most anti-subjectivists, is anxious to maintain an absolute externality, independence, and otherness of the world of objects as against the theory of the objects being only a form of the inner subjective series of cognitions. As against the subjectivist Vijnānāvādi, who does not make any absolute distinction between the subjective and the objective, it is thought necessary to uphold that the two separate worlds of the inner cognitions, and the outer objects, never do fuse into each other, or appear indifferently both as subjective states and as outer objects. His forces of mind are something like this: To admit that cognitions are self-luminous is to admit that an object can be both a subject and an object, and to admit this, is to play the game of the subjectivists, ergo, cognitions cannot be self-cognized.

Kumārila, therefore, maintains that nothing can be both a subject and an object and that the two functions of the knower and the known cannot belong to one and the same cognition. Cognition therefore cannot be self-cognized, because a wide gulf between the knower and the known must at all cost be maintained in order to combat the subjectivist. Cognitions cannot be admitted to be their own objects whatever may be the consequences of a theory of cognition by another cognition or by inference.

Thus, pressed by the need to maintain an absolute distinction of the internal states of cognitions and the external world of objects, as against the solipsist, Kumārila forgets what he had previously propounded in his second sūtra, pressed under a similar need of maintaining the immediate and the intrinsic validity of the Vedic injunction. He obviously thought that without the theory of an intrinsic validity of cognitions, the inherent authoritativeness of the Vedas could not be maintained. But in his zeal to demolish completely the subjective idealism, he overshot the mark by attacking the 'Svatāḥprākāśatva' of cognitions, not seeing the inconsistency in it with his own earlier position.

It is a little difficult to see why, in order to restore the objectivity of our cognitions against the subjectivists, it should be considered obligatory to deny self-cognizability of cognitions. Yet the practice has been fairly common with some philosophers, in spite of the repeated declaration that by the theory of the 'Svatāḥprākāśatva' of cognitions is not meant that either cognitions do not have an extra-mental basis, or that cognitions are their one subject and the object. On the contrary, a theory of self-luminosity of cognition is perfectly compatible with the belief in the fullest externality of the